

partly the reason behind some of the opposition to the secure boot from the Linux and open source community.

Q Does that mean Microsoft is not clear about its intentions on whether to be open source or not?

Microsoft doesn't have any intentions of being open source. Microsoft has intentions of meeting their commercial goals, as any company does, including Canonical. We choose to do it the open source way. We think that's a better and more effective way, while Microsoft chooses a different path. In choosing its path, it has become more accepting of open source alternatives and it recognises the need to work together with those options. But I don't think it's correct to say that Microsoft has gone open source or is going open source. I think the company's view of open source has matured and it recognises it as a player in the ecosystem. That doesn't mean Microsoft is not going to compete against open source. In general, we all know that fair competition largely results in a better experience for the customer. There are obvious historical issues with Microsoft about fair competition, but as far as our dealings with it are concerned, it has been a very good partner around the Azure collaboration. It's a solid partnership that can benefit both the organisations.

Q What is coming up in the future between Canonical and Microsoft? Do we see more partnerships between proprietary and open source companies on any other level?

I don't have anything specific to share but I think, in general, that's the trend. I think people will use more and more of Linux and Ubuntu, and there will be many more touch points with Microsoft. Things like cloud computing will improve the relationship, simply because of the nature of the cloud—which means people are freely moving between platforms. I think the number of places where those platform choices or operating system choices will occur are going to increase, and it's in everybody's interest to make those smooth interactions. I don't have a specific example of what that may look like but the days of Microsoft really bashing open source are ending.

Q How do you view the open source community in India, in general?

Ubuntu has a strong community in terms of advocacy and translations, but there is less contribution around code. I don't know the reason behind that. India is one of the countries where we see lower code contribution. We can cite specific reasons like the language barrier. We however have not done any specific analysis on the Indian community. But the Ubuntu community in India is quite strong and active. We have got a good strong local team. In my perception, people in India are very technical and knowledgeable. They are making a lot of good contributions to the code but you don't see these contributors mixing or networking in the community, the reasons for which are

unknown to me. But when we held the Ubuntu Developer's Day, we had people from IBM, Intel, ARM and lots of very hardcore kernel developers. India has a good amount of technical people who do loads of good work but you don't see them in community meet-ups.

In the West, contributing to code is like a luxury. Contributors may have some other source of income and contributing to code could just be their hobby. But in India, the scene is entirely different. Many contributors do it for their bread and butter. People start contributing to Linux and then make it to IBM or Intel, which, in a way, is a success story. Participation in the community leads to a job. That's a good reason to get involved in open source and that is, overall, the community and open source dynamics.

Q Ubuntu Cloud Day has just happened. What was the response to it in India and will we see more such events being organised in the country?

Absolutely! We do not have anything planned yet, but the previous event was largely a success and it's something that we would like to repeat. By and large, our work in India has been around the desktop but, increasingly, there is server and cloud interest in Ubuntu and I think Ubuntu Cloud Day was an example of that. I think that will continue and grow. About 180 people came for the event. Before that we held the Ubuntu Developer's Day where around 350 people participated. We had an entry fee of Rs 1000, and we had enough participation despite that. I think ours was one of the most successful cloud events compared to the ones organised by other companies. There were lots of senior level people from the IT industry who came to attend the event.

"Ubuntu for Android is a particularly interesting offering not just for enterprises but also for the high growth markets like India."

Q What else do you plan to do in the Indian market?

One of the exciting things that we hope to bring to India is Ubuntu for Android. This is the ability to run a full Ubuntu desktop on an Android phone, and when you plug that phone into a monitor and a keyboard, you have the full Ubuntu desktop experience powered by the phone. We believe that's a really interesting proposition for a number of reasons. It will be beneficial for enterprises in terms of reducing devices that an enterprise IT shop has to manage because of the smoother experience that it gives to the users. You just have to plug in your phone and have the same contacts and same data on the desktop as well. Ubuntu for Android is particularly relevant in a market like India where for so many people their phone is their first computer. So by merging these